

Tiv Consonant Sounds and Tone Examples

1. Tiv Consonant Sounds

Tiv has thirty-three consonant sounds. Some notable ones include: - Voiceless palatal fricative /kw/ as in kwende (shoulder), Kwagh (thing), kwase (woman), kwar (share), kwav (bachelorhood) - Voiced alveolar fricative /z/ as in zende (walk/journey), zege (big), zwa (mouth), zange (swiftly), za (go) - Pre-nasal velar /m-/ , e.g., mngbônghôm /mngbɔ:ghɔ:m/ (nearness/fast approaching), mhôðnum /m-hɔ: num/ (pity) - Labial-velar pre-nasalized plosives /ŋgb/ and /mgb/

These consonants are described using place/point of articulation, manner of articulation, and voicing.

2. Tiv Tone System

Tiv has three major tones: - **High** [ˈ]: yá (eat/home), shá (up), áyém (race), yém (go), wákwagh (advise), zé (emphatic not) - **Mid** [ˊ]: yèmèn (going), lyèmèn (slippery), ashèn (since) - **Low** [-]: sēngē (pretend), sēndē (execute/mate), sǎā (except)

2.1 Tone Effects Examples

Tiv Word	Tone	Meaning
Íú	high	mortal
Íū	high	be
tsá	high	put up for the night/tail
tsā	low	a piece of farmland
zéndé	high	walk
zēndē	mid	journey
ūndū	low	leave
úndú	high	he/she climbs
hóndó	high	whistle
hòndò	low	he/she shelves
hūndū	high	disorganise
húndū	high	he/she crazes
kāhā	low	different
káhā	high	cultivate

Tiv Word	Tone	Meaning
kàhà	low	turn
tòr	low	king
tór	high	pestle
tǒr	mid	a specie of mouse
tǒr	low	eaves

2.2 Plural Formation by Tone

Singular	Plural
Ìkyúreke	íkyùreke
ìwā	íwá
ìyôngò	íyôngò
ígò	ígò
íkyā	íkyá

2.3 Aspectual Differentiation by Tone

- **wà:** advise — Wá un kwagh ade ibumegh (Advise him to stop being foolish)
- **wā:** advised — U wā un kwagh shachiu ade ibumegh (You advised him/her)
- **wá:** advise — Ka u wá un kwagh man a soo u den ibumegh ga (You do advise him/her yet he/she does not stop)

2.4 Syntactic Tone Effects

- Á wàà — He/she blames
- À wáá — He/she escapes
- Kwagh yùà Torkwase — Something embitters Torkwase
- Kwagh yúa Torkwase — Something took up Torkwase